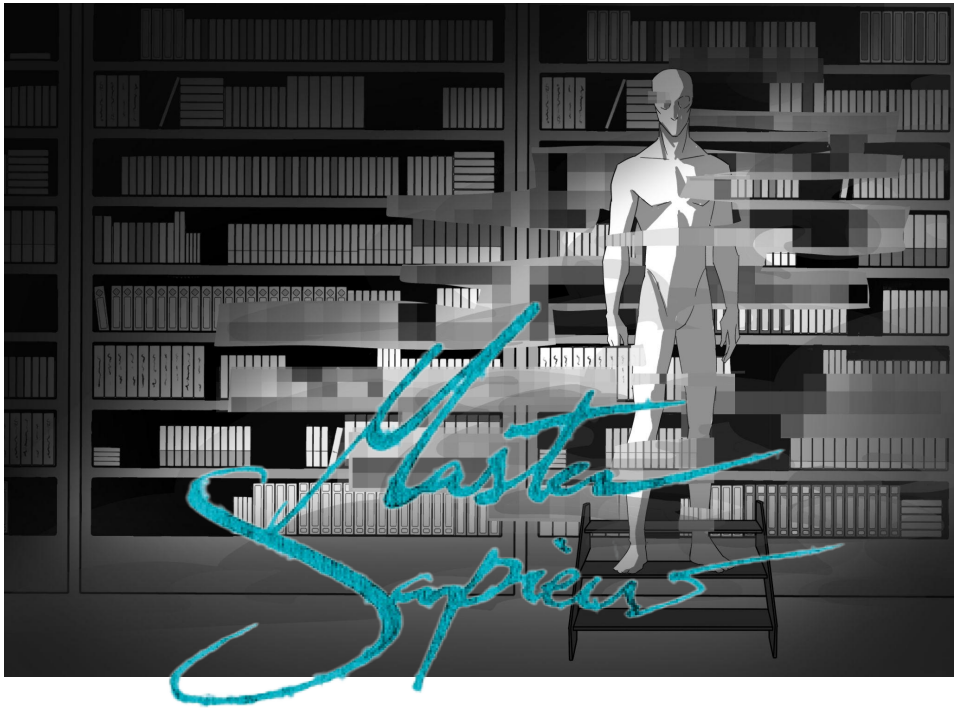
12 Pingüinos
animation studio



Adult Animated Miniseries

5 × 18-minute episodes · approx.

An original concept and script by David Alonso

Executive production and animation: 12 Pingüinos · Manuel Sirgo and Fran Villalobos



Visual development — work in progress

The Series

History is not a monument to contemplate.
It is a biological archive to be mined
to engineer a "perfect future".

London, 1890. In an isolated Gothic abbey, the Knowledge Club safeguards human knowledge against the collapse of time.

Then reality begins to change. Objects from 1927 emerge from the fog. Victorian mouldings flatten. Doors vanish without a trace.

Behind the anomaly are the Master Sapiens: assimilated beings from the future, led by Buffon D., a former founder of the Club. Their aim is to extract the talent of history's great minds and eliminate biological imperfection.

As the abbey is rewritten around them, the Clerics descend into paranoia.

The Knowledge Club

Shrouded in London's winter fog, a desolate abbey of iron and glass rises like a vast Victorian glasshouse—part library, part botanical garden.

Within its walls, H. G. Wells and the Clerics of the Knowledge Club guard the time machine. Their founding purpose was to preserve human knowledge against the collapse of time.



H. G. Wells

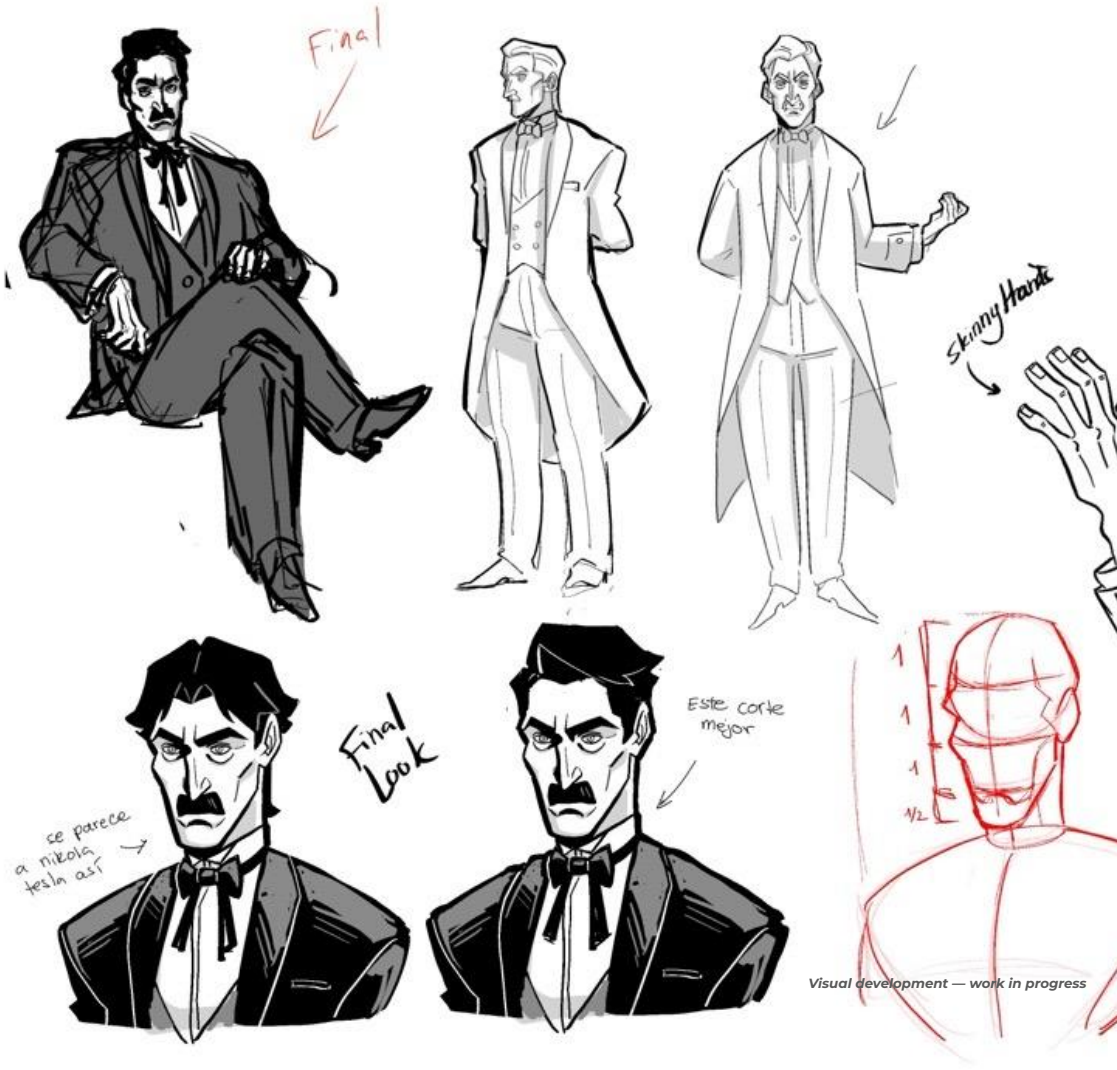
The series' moral compass—not an innocent witness.

Within the Knowledge Club, Wells guards the time machine and the belief that knowledge must be preserved, not extracted from those who hold it.

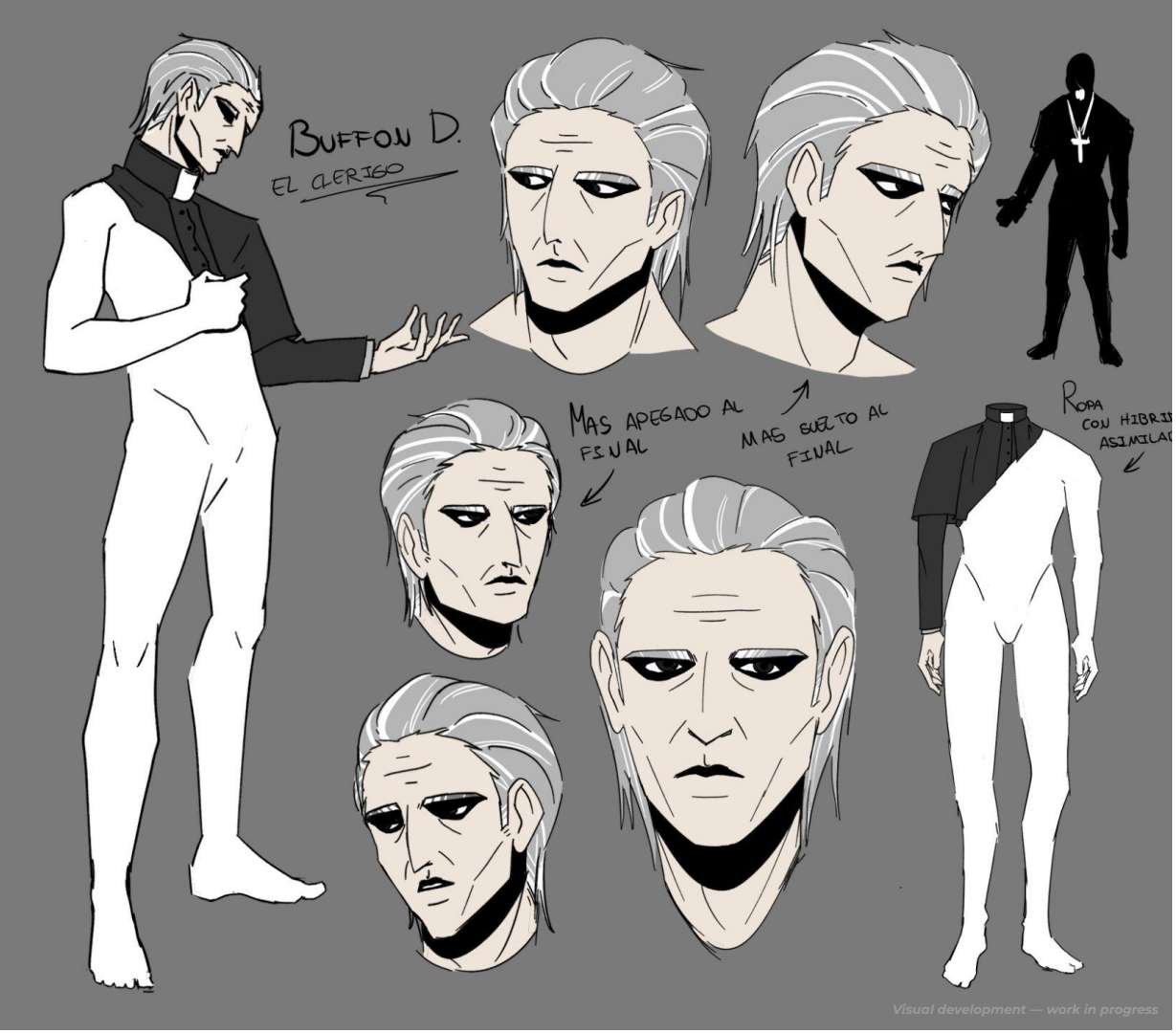
As the Abbey is rewritten and the Clerics begin to change, he struggles to protect them while confronting the Club's shared guilt—and his own. His understanding of the machine offers a means of resistance, but neither certainty nor innocence.

Against Buffon's pursuit of perfection, Wells defends the irregularities that make life human.

His resistance ultimately rests not on mastering time, but on an act of writing: preserving a testimony that extraction cannot replace.



Visual development — work in progress



Buffon D. and the Master Sapiens

They cross time to extract knowledge—not to preserve it.

Buffon D., a former founder of the Knowledge Club, leads the Master Sapiens across time to extract the knowledge and talent of history's great minds. Their goal is to engineer a "perfect future" stripped of biological imperfection.

At the Abbey, extraction and assimilation turn the threat inward: Clerics become Master Sapiens. Those entrusted with safeguarding human knowledge become agents of its extraction.

The horror is not simply that the enemy has entered the Abbey. It is that its guardians can become part of the system rewriting it.

A World Built to Be Rewritten

Adult 2D animation · Science-fiction thriller / Biopunk / Psychological horror
Minimalist ligne claire rooted in European auteur comics.

The threat doesn't invade; it edits.

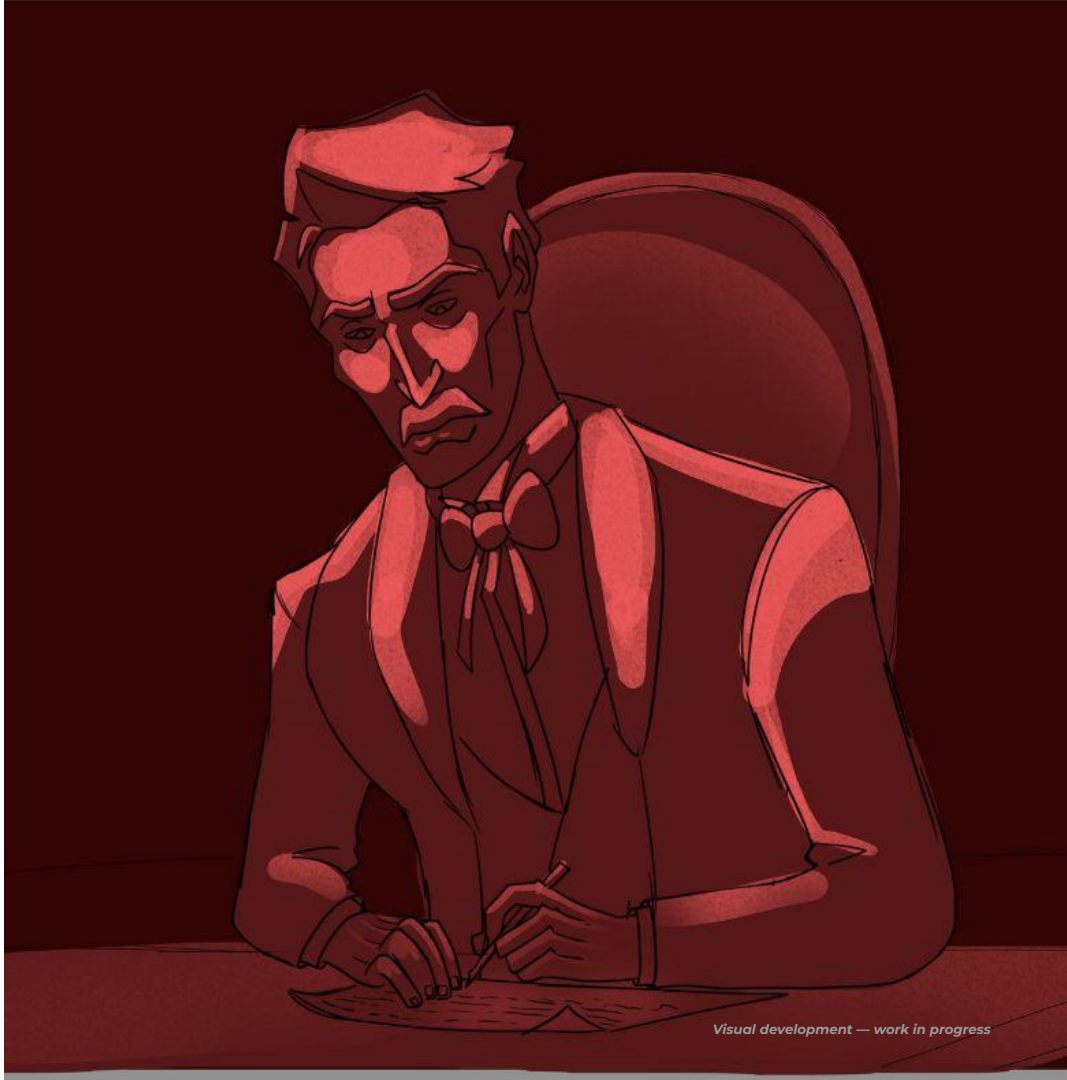
Horror emerges through the loss of physical texture: wood flattens, stone becomes code, architecture folds in on itself. As familiar spaces turn unrecognisable, the characters can no longer tell who—or what—has already been edited.

Why 2D animation

Across six stages of degradation, Victorian space is transformed into a two-dimensional data diagram. Ligne-claire animation makes this transition part of the visual language: the world is not merely threatened within the frame; its very construction is rewritten.

Algorithm Blue

Bronze, wood, soot and cold greys define the nineteenth-century world. Algorithm Blue breaks into this palette as a flat, hypnotic signal of biomechanical extraction and assimilation.

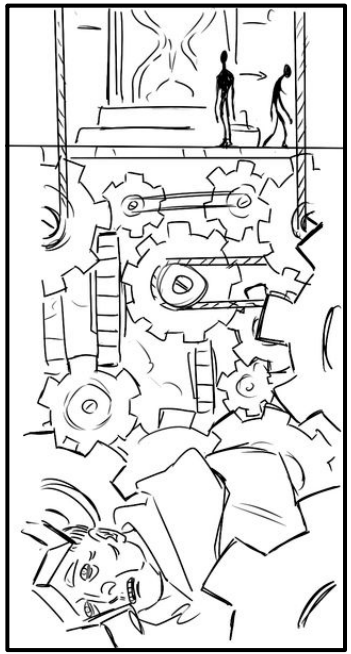


Episode	Title	Story	Episode ending
1	The Generator	Cleric X disappears beneath the library. Above, Wells studies a seed in his laboratory while the four Clerics retreat into private rituals of guilt. Their uneasy routine breaks when the fog brings impossible objects into the Abbey: a newspaper clipping from 1927, a photograph of Madrid and a black sheet bearing an unfamiliar geometric pattern.	Wells keeps the mysterious object. He recognises its fibre—but offers no explanation.
2	The Anomaly	As the Club debates abandoning its project, time freezes inside the Abbey. When movement resumes, a Master Sapiens unit, V1R, stands among the shelves, studying Wells and the Clerics. Nearby, wood loses its grain and books flatten into blocks of colour.	V1R vanishes. The pixelated scar in the bookshelf remains.
3	The Labyrinth	TThe Abbey is silently edited: corridors lengthen, familiar views become impossible and the laboratory door disappears. Nitric acid accidentally splashed on V1R disrupts its biomechanical order, making it momentarily more human. Seeking help, Cleric 1 climbs to the observatory beacon, where the spreading pixelation brushes his hand.	Three flashes reach into the fog. London gives no answer.
4	Vote 157	A debate over Vote 157 exposes the Club's shared guilt over what it allowed Buffon D. to do. While they argue, the library passes through six stages of degradation, becoming an information trap. A copper vein appears on Cleric 1's hand. Suspecting assimilation, Wells gathers the group in the botanical laboratory for a hygrometer test.	Wells brings the sensor towards Cleric 1. It stops one centimetre from his skin. Cut to black.
5	The Last Draft	The group retreats underground, where copper, lead and deliberate disorder resist the editing. Cleric 2 loses access to his own voice. Wells uses the Generator to repel the Master Sapiens, but Cleric 1 defects and Wells accidentally kills the assimilating Cleric 3 while protecting Cleric 4. Buffon disconnects the Generator. Rather than pursue him, Wells retrieves the Last Draft and copies it by hand.	The Last Draft is recovered in Madrid on 14 March 2027—the very day it was written.

Opening Sequence — Storyboard Development







Storyboard — opening of Episode 1 · work in progress.

Creator & Production

12 Pingüinos — Executive production and animation

Animation studio founded in 1996, with over 25 years of continuous track record in the international audiovisual industry.
Goya Award — Best Animated Film, for *Wrinkles (Arrugas)*, 2012.
Goya Award — Best Adapted Screenplay, for *Wrinkles (Arrugas)*, 2012.
Goya Award — Best Animated Short Film, for *Cazatalentos*, 2019.
Goya Award — Best Animated Short Film, for *Chicken (Pollo)*, by Manuel Sirgo, 2002.

12 Pingüinos has operated up to three studios of its own (Madrid, Ciudad Real, and Valladolid) with a team that has exceeded 150 direct professionals, offering full production services: script, storyboard, animatics, layout, model sheet, backgrounds, 2D and 3D animation, cut-out, clean-up, in-between, editing, and sound. It has provided animation services to studios such as Disney, Warner Bros., Fox, and HBO, and has collaborated with firms including Hanna-Barbera and Cartoon Network. The studio has completed over 100 animation projects throughout its history.

Manuel Sirgo and Fran Villalobos bring to the project this consolidated experience in auteur animation production, with official recognition from the Spanish Film Academy, which guarantees both the technical solvency of the drawing and animation team and the management capacity required for a project of this scale

David Alonso — Original concept, direction, and script

Author of the concept, the narrative bible, and the original script for Master Sapiens, with a narrative development already consolidated.

Development Status & Production

Master Sapiens is an animated science-fiction and horror miniseries for adults. In Spain, animation services for international TV and SVOD productions are well established, and animated features are also made, but original dramatic series of this kind are still uncommon. Mature animated drama is gaining ground on Western TV and SVOD, and we think there is room for a Spanish-produced series in this field.
The project brings together David Alonso, film director and writer (e.g. «Memorias del ángel caído»), and the experience of "12 Pingüinos", the award-winning Spanish animation studio currently developing the series.

Development plan

"12 Pingüinos" is financing development at its own pace to keep the risk in proportion. The aim is to produce the materials that can open the door to further funding:

Concept art and an animatic for a 2-minute 2D teaser trailer.
A short series bible of about 30 pages.
Target date: February 2027.

After that, we plan to extend the bible and add concept art, model sheets and designs for scenes and props. Layouts and backgrounds would start once a partner joins.
The teaser will be our main sales tool with the partners we are looking at first: SVOD/OTT platforms, which are leading this kind of content in Spain, Europe and elsewhere.

Development Status & Production

The story is set in 19th-century England, with links to present-day Madrid. We keep a European feel and plan to work with a Spanish actor of standing for the Spanish dub and the lead character's likeness.
The series is aimed at an international audience for adult animation.

What we need

Development funding of €30,000. This covers the whole teaser, including dubbing and subtitling in all required languages (Castilian Spanish, British English and the languages of the co-producing countries), and the production, financing and marketing materials. Meetings with platforms are planned in Madrid; if travel is needed, we estimate €2,500 more.

We are looking for a European co-producer who can give access to European subsidies and other funding. We are open to discussing how the team should be set up so that the co-production works for every country involved (certificates of origin and related matters), and to agreeing a structure that gives each partner fair terms and credit according to its involvement.





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